

Product Design Assessment

Duration: 2 hours

1. About the platform

Our client is a large investment company. They use an internal, AI-powered workspace where different teams get their own set of AI agents to help with day-to-day work. Think of it as a private, company-only version of a chat-based AI assistant — but trained on the company's own documents, tone and templates, and wrapped in a proper product experience.

One of these agents belongs to the Corporate Communications team. This team is responsible for everything the company says publicly and internally — formal letters, greetings to partners and governments, staff announcements, press material and executive talking points. Their agent helps them draft this content faster while keeping it perfectly on-brand.

2. The specific workflow you are looking at

Throughout the year, the company sends formal greeting letters for international observances — national days of partner countries, cultural new years, founding days and similar occasions. There are roughly 20 of these every year.

Each occasion has its own rules:

- Audience — some greetings go to external partners and governments, some go to internal staff, and some need both.
- Language — internal greetings are always English only. External greetings are usually English plus the recipient country's language (Arabic, Mandarin, Japanese, French, Korean, Uzbek, Spanish, Turkish...), though a few are English only.
- Tone — external letters are formal and diplomatic; internal ones are warm and inclusive.
- Dates — most are a single day, but some occasions span a date range.

3. How the team does this today (manual process)

There is no system. The whole thing runs on memory, spreadsheets and repetition:

1. Someone on the team keeps a document listing the observance dates, and has to remember to check it. Occasions are noticed late, or missed entirely.
2. When a date is approaching, a team member goes hunting for last year's letter for that same occasion, digging through shared drives and old email threads.
3. They open a general AI chat tool and paste in context manually — the old letter, the company's writing guideline, notes about tone — and explain: "this is our style, write a new one like this."
4. They re-explain the same rules every single time: who it's for, how formal it should be, which languages are needed.
5. They copy the output into Word, fix the formatting, then repeat the entire process again for the second language version.
6. For occasions that need both an internal and an external version, they do the whole cycle twice.
7. The draft goes to a colleague for review, comes back with edits, and the loop repeats. Older versions get lost along the way.
8. Finally the letter is saved somewhere — inconsistently — and next year, the hunt starts all over again.

Net result: the same work is redone ~20 times a year, quality depends on who happens to do it, deadlines are missed, and there is no reliable record of what was sent last time.

4. The problem to solve

Design how this workflow could work if the platform handled the repetition instead of the person.

You should think about two kinds of people:

- A communications team member, who reviews, refines and downloads the letters.
- Someone who owns the configuration — the list of occasions, their dates, audiences and languages — and keeps it accurate as it changes year to year.

5. What to deliver in two hours

We care about your thinking far more than pixel polish. Low-fidelity is completely fine.

- A short problem framing — what you think the real problem is, in your own words.
- A high-level flow showing how the automated process would work end to end, including where a human steps in.
- The key decisions and trade-offs you made, plus anything you deliberately left out.
- The questions you would ask stakeholders before designing this for real.

6. What we're evaluating

- Problem framing — do you solve the real problem, not just the stated one?
- Systems thinking — how well you handle configuration, automation and the human checkpoint together.
- Handling complexity — audiences, multiple languages, versions, edge cases.
- Prioritisation — knowing what matters most in a two-hour scope.
- Communication — how clearly you explain and defend your reasoning.

Assumptions are welcome — just state them. There is no single correct answer; we're interested in how you get to yours.